

READ-ME-FIRST PUBLICATION GUIDE

Public Review Release Notes

Publication inventory, review boundary, comment procedure, claim language, version control, and release gates

Field	Controlled value
Specification	AERA-001
Edition	1.2 Working Draft
Package build	AERA-001-1.2WD-20260807.1
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Affiliation	Independent author
Document date	7 August 2026
Review status	Developmental-review candidate; public review not open

STATUS: AERA 1.2 WD is an independently authored discussion draft. It is not an adopted standard, certification scheme, government publication, NIST submission, or evidence of external support or endorsement.

1. Purpose, Release Boundary, and Changes

This package is a candidate for structured developmental review; it does not open public review. Once the release gates are cleared and review is formally opened, reviewers will be asked to evaluate implementability, testability, threat completeness, consequence classification, human-control requirements, external mappings, governance, and the evidence needed for pilot validation.

RELEASE BOUNDARY: Publication does not establish operational validity, legal sufficiency, regulatory compliance, external-framework equivalence, certification eligibility, consensus, or endorsement by NIST, ISO, IEEE, CISA, DoD, DOE, or any other organization.

1.1 Material changes from 1.1 RC1

Area	1.2 WD change
Status and ownership	Reissued as an independently authored working draft; same-author integrity review is labeled I1 self-assessment.
Normative perimeter	Clarified controlling sections, canonical register, explicitly normative tables/clauses, and release-blocking divergence.
Conformance	Defined CONFORMING, CONDITIONALLY CONFORMING, NONCONFORMING, and INDETERMINATE; separated applicability and result.
Evidence state	Requires capability claims to distinguish PRESENT, MONITORED, ACTIVE IN PATH, USED IN COMPUTATION, and VALIDATED EFFECTIVE.
Governance	Added role, consensus, dissent, mapping, evidence-bound claim, release, and publication-family controls.
NIST readiness	Added AI RMF attribute assessment, IR 8477/OLIR mapping method, lifecycle/measurement/ERM sources, and bounded engagement routes.
Registers	Reconciled 199 requirements, 25 threats, and 69 controlled sources; added separate mapping-development ledger.

NORMATIVE CHANGE: AERA 1.2 WD is a new controlled edition. Review records against 1.1 RC1 remain historical and do not silently migrate to 1.2 WD.

2. Controlled Publication Set

The fixed-layout and editable artifacts below form one controlled review package. A release is complete only when every published filename exists, metadata and visible edition labels agree, and the checksum manifest matches the distributed byte streams.

Artifact	Role	Use
AERA_1.2_WD_Autonomous_Enterprise_Reference_Architecture.docx / .pdf	Authoritative specification and fixed-layout edition	Full architecture, normative requirements, threat model, conformance, maturity, governance, and references.
AERA_1.2_WD_Architecture_Integrity_and_NIST_Readiness_Review.docx / .pdf	I1 support assessment	Author self-assessment of package integrity, NIST readiness, open findings, and release gates.
AERA_1.2_WD_Public_Review_Brief.docx / .pdf	Reviewer orientation	Concise architecture thesis, transaction, control model, NIST boundary, changes, and questions.
AERA_1.2_WD_Public_Review_Release_Notes.docx / .pdf	Read-me-first guide	Package inventory, change summary, comment procedure, claims, and version controls.
AERA_1.2_WD_Requirement_Register.xlsx / .csv	Canonical machine-readable derivative	Filterable register for 199 active normative requirements.
AERA_1.2_WD_Threat_Control_Test_Matrix.xlsx / .csv	Threat traceability	Controls, negative tests, and evidence for 25 decision-authority threats.
AERA_1.2_WD_Source_Register.xlsx / .csv	Source control	Edition, status, access date, direction, and caveat for 69 sources.
AERA_1.2_WD_Review_Comment_Matrix.xlsx	Controlled review record	Reviewer-entered identifiers, comments, dispositions, and embedded same-source snapshots.
AERA_1.2_WD_NIST_Mapping_Development_Ledger.xlsx	Mapping workspace	Separate candidate lanes for AI RMF, CSF 2.0, and SP 800-53; not OLIR submission-ready.

MANIFEST CONTROL: Do not rename files, add a '_Validated_' marker, or distribute a partial set while retaining a checksum manifest created for a different inventory. Any byte change requires new hashes and a new manifest date.

3. Review and Comment Procedure

3.1 Review scope

- Decision-authority transaction completeness and implementability.
- Requirement clarity, testability, feasibility, duplication, applicability, and profile assignment.
- Threat coverage across authority, identity, evidence, policy, enforcement, timing/PNT, effect, recovery, learning, supply chain, and human oversight.
- Consequence classes, cumulative risk, human-control floors, degraded operation, and recovery semantics.
- External mappings, source status, semantic direction, caveats, and evidence-reuse limits.
- Conformance, maturity, assessment independence, inter-rater reliability, metrics, usability, and pilot evidence.

3.2 Submission procedure

1. Enter substantive comments in AERA_1.2_WD_Review_Comment_Matrix.xlsx; do not change a previously assigned Comment ID.
2. Cite AERA-001, Version 1.2 WD, the artifact filename, section/page, and any requirement, threat, table, figure, source, or mapping row.
3. Classify the concern as technical, conformance, evidence, mapping, source status, editorial, accessibility, security, privacy, safety, or implementation guidance.
4. State the issue precisely, explain the technical rationale and mission consequence, and provide supporting evidence.
5. Propose replacement language, an acceptance criterion, mapping rationale, test, or corrective action where practical.
6. Identify reviewer role, relevant competence, affiliation, sponsorship, and conflicts when review is not anonymous.

3.3 Disposition values

Acknowledgment records receipt only; disposition remains controlled by the AERA change process. Use stable review outcomes such as ACCEPTED, ACCEPTED WITH MODIFICATION, DEFERRED, REJECTED, DUPLICATE, WITHDRAWN, or NEEDS EVIDENCE. Each disposition must include rationale, owner, affected artifacts, target edition, and verification status.

4. Claim Language, Version Control, and Release Gates

Use	Do not use
AERA 1.2 Working Draft	final standard or approved standard
independently authored external technical discussion draft	NIST, government, industry, or consensus publication
designed for compatibility with selected NIST outcomes	NIST-supported, NIST-approved, NIST-aligned, or NIST-endorsed
candidate mapping under IR 8477 methodology	NIST mapping or OLIR-ready without completed evidence
mapped to / informed by, with version, direction, and caveat	reciprocal compliance or certification established by AERA
bounded pilot evidence	validated framework or proven maturity model
I1 author self-assessment	independent review

4.1 Required release gates

Gate	Acceptance evidence
G1 Source reconciliation	Requirement, threat, source, mapping, and comment snapshots match the controlled source.
G2 Fixed-layout QA	Every DOCX/PDF page is rendered and visually inspected; no clipping, overlap, missing glyphs, stale navigation, or broken tables.
G3 Workbook QA	Every sheet renders; formulas, validations, filters, frozen panes, counts, and error scans pass.
G4 Metadata	Author, affiliation, edition, status, dates, titles, and non-endorsement boundary agree across artifacts.
G5 Rights	License, redistribution, contribution, derivative-work, and submission terms are approved.
G6 Integrity	A complete SHA-256 manifest is generated after final bytes are frozen and validated against the distributed set.
G7 Critical defects	No unresolved P0 publication or safety/security defect remains; open P1/P2 issues are visible and owned.

4.2 Version and integrity rules

A later edition does not silently replace an earlier review record. Comments, citations, mappings, pilot results, and conformance claims remain bound to the exact edition, subject, boundary, evidence package, date, and expiration conditions assessed.

PUBLISH ONLY AFTER GATES: The working draft may be posted for developmental review only after the fixed artifact inventory, rights decision, visual QA, metadata, and checksum gates are complete. Public availability still does not create consensus or endorsement.